

Matrices

(P1)

A discrete dynamical system is described by the following transition matrix, T ,

$$T = \begin{bmatrix} 0.6 & 0.5 \\ 0.4 & 0.5 \end{bmatrix}$$

The state of the system is defined by the proportion of population with a particular characteristic.

- Use the characteristic polynomial T to find its eigenvalues. [2]
- Find the corresponding eigenvectors of T . [2]
- Hence find the steady state matrix S of the system. [2]

a) The characteristic poly. of T is

$$\det(T - \lambda I) = \begin{vmatrix} 0.6 - \lambda & 0.5 \\ 0.4 & 0.5 - \lambda \end{vmatrix}$$
$$= \lambda^2 - 1.1\lambda + 0.1$$

$$\det(T - \lambda I) = 0$$

$$\lambda_1 = 0.1, \quad \lambda_2 = 1$$

b) Let x_1 and x_2 be the corresponding eigenvectors. For $\lambda_1 = 0.1$, we have.

$$(T - \lambda_1 I)x_1 = 0$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0.5 & 0.5 \\ 0.4 & 0.4 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \end{bmatrix} = 0$$

$$0.5a + 0.5b = 0$$

$$a + b = 0$$

$$a = -b$$

$$\text{So } x_1 = \begin{bmatrix} -b \\ b \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$